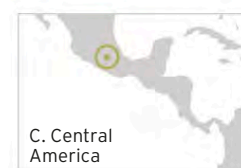




Church of Santa Prisca

A monumental twin-towered church exemplifying the colonial architecture and art of the New Spanish Baroque



The highly ornate Church of Santa Prisca in Taxco, Mexico, was built on the orders of local silver mine owner José de la Borda between 1751 and 1758 as an expression of his gratitude for his riches.

On either side of the main entrance at the west front are two lofty towers that can be seen from everywhere in the town. Their lower portions, of plain pink stone, support belfries with the elaborate sculpted decoration characteristic of the New Spanish Baroque style. The facade surrounding the entrance is also highly decorated and features a large central relief panel, as well as carvings of saints such as Santa Prisca and

St. Sebastian. At the apex is a sculpture of the Assumption of Mary. At the other end of the church, there is a dome covered with brightly colored tiles.

Ornate interior

The interior of the church is no less magnificent, its decorations centering on themes of martyrdom. There are nine baroque altarpieces adorning the nave and transept, echoing the style of the main facade, and others in the chapels of the transept. On the walls are paintings by the Mexican artist Miguel Cabrera, commissioned for the church by de la Borda.



△ BAROQUE RELIEF

The central panel of the facade depicting the baptism of Christ is surrounded by an oval frame featuring ornamental framework.

The Church of Santa Prisca was the **tallest building** in **Mexico** from **1758** until **1806**